

## 23STCV16026 23STCV16026

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 734

Hearing date: 2026-09-04

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Case Number: 23STCV16026 Hearing Date: September 4, 2026 Dept: 734

The

following tentative ruling is issued pursuant to Rule of Court 3.1308 at 12:43 PM on September 3, 2026.

Rule

of Court 3.1308(a)(1) provides that a “tentative ruling will become the ruling of the court if the court has not directed oral argument by its tentative ruling and notice of intent to appear has not been given.”

The

Court does not desire oral argument on the motion addressed herein. Notice of intent to appear is REQUIRED pursuant to California Rule of Court 3.1308(a)(1).

No

later than 4:00 p.m. on September 3, 2026, the moving and opposing parties must provide notice to ALL OTHER PARTIES and the staff of Department 734 whether the party intends to (1) appear and argue the motion, or (2) submit to the tentative ruling.

Notice to Department 734 should be sent by

email to [smcdept734@lacourt.org](mailto:smcdept734@lacourt.org), with opposing parties copied on the email. The high volume of telephone calls to Department 734 may delay the Court's receipt of notice, so telephonic notice to 213-830-0776 should be reserved for situations where parties are unable to give notice by email.

Plaintiff alleges that she

suffered disability discrimination and retaliation for requesting accommodations and for taking medical leave.

Defendant 1736 Family Crisis Center moves to bifurcate the issue of punitive damages.

#### TENTATIVE RULING

Defendant

1736 Family Crisis Center's motion to bifurcate the issue of punitive damages is GRANTED. Defendant is entitled to an order bifurcating the issue of punitive damages and to preclude evidence of Defendants' financial condition pertaining to punitive damages during the liability phase of trial until after the jury finds of malice, oppression or fraud, as set forth in Civ. Code § 3295(a), (b), (d).